

Students Relationship with AI

Currently, many students, especially in the U.S., are using AI in ways that may not support real learning. By this, I mean that some students use AI mainly to finish assignments rather than to understand the material. Completing an assignment is very different from completing an assignment while also learning and retaining the information, which is the main purpose of most work assigned by teachers and professors.

I believe AI should be used as an assistant, not as a replacement for a student's own effort. In other words, AI should not simply do the work for students; it should help guide them, provide ideas, and support them as they improve their own work. In the future, I would like to see AI tools designed to encourage students to think through problems, learn from the process, and use AI as a resource rather than a shortcut.

Why This Issue Matters

This topic matters because AI is becoming a normal part of school life, but students are still learning how to use it responsibly. If students only use AI to get quick answers, they may miss the opportunity to practice critical thinking, problem-solving, and writing skills. A better approach would be to create AI tools that encourage learning instead of replacing it.

Project Concept and Users

For my summer internship project at Microsoft, I would like to develop an AI model or agent that helps mentor students by providing guidance, study support, and useful knowledge that can contribute to their academic growth. My main goal is for this AI tool to support students, but I also think it could be valuable for teachers. Educators could use it to gain insight into creating stronger lessons, offering better feedback, and understanding how students can learn more effectively. Overall, this AI would be designed for people in education, whether they are students or teachers.

How the AI Mentor Would Work

The AI mentor would be designed to guide students step by step instead of immediately giving them the final answer. For example, if a student is struggling with an essay, the AI could ask questions, suggest an outline, explain weak areas, or help the student organize their ideas. If a student is working on math or science, the AI could provide hints and examples while still requiring the student to complete the work themselves.

Benefits for Students

For students, this AI tool could provide extra support outside the classroom. Some students may feel nervous asking questions in class, while others may need more time to understand a topic. An AI mentor could give students a place to review concepts, practice skills, and receive feedback in a low-pressure way. This would help students become more confident and independent learners.

Benefits for Teachers

For teachers, the AI mentor could be used as a tool to better understand where students may be struggling. It could help identify common questions, confusing topics, or areas where students need more practice. Teachers could then use that information to adjust lessons, give more helpful feedback, and spend more time supporting students directly.

Conclusion

Overall, I believe AI has the potential to improve education if it is used in the right way. It should not take away from student effort, but instead support students as they learn, practice, and grow. My internship project would focus on building an AI mentor that helps students use technology responsibly while also giving teachers another resource to support learning.